Reach Truck



Category: **Retail, Logistics & Warehouse** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Reach trucks

What it is used for

A reach truck is a powered warehouse vehicle designed to lift, move, and place palletised loads in storage aisles. Pre-use inspection, stable load handling, and controlled driving help prevent collisions, dropped loads, and tip-over incidents.

Main parts

- Operator compartment and controls allow the driver to operate the truck.
- Mast raises and lowers the load.
- Forks support pallets and approved loads.
- Reach mechanism extends or retracts the forks and load.
- Drive wheel and motor move the truck.
- Steering system controls travel direction.
- Battery supplies power on electric models.
- Load capacity plate states permitted load limits and conditions.

Before you start

1. Only trained and authorised operators should use the reach truck.
2. Check the load capacity plate and confirm the load weight and centre are within limits.
3. Inspect forks, mast, reach mechanism, tyres, brakes, steering, and overhead guard for damage.
4. Check the battery, controls, warning devices, and hydraulic system for leaks or faults.
5. Ensure the travel route and storage aisle are clear and the floor is suitable.
6. Wear required PPE and adjust the seat or operator position according to the manual.

How to use

1. Mount the truck using the designated access points and secure the operator restraint where fitted.
2. Switch on the truck and check warning indicators and control functions.
3. Approach the pallet slowly with the forks lowered and aligned with the openings.
4. Insert the forks fully and evenly beneath the pallet without striking the load.
5. Lift the load only enough to clear the floor and retract the reach mechanism as instructed.
6. Travel at a controlled speed with the load low and the mast in the recommended travel position.
7. Slow down at corners, intersections, doorways, and areas with limited visibility.
8. Stop in front of the destination, extend the reach mechanism as required, and raise the load to the correct shelf height.

9. Place the load securely, lower the forks clear of the pallet, and retract the reach mechanism before reversing.
10. Park in the designated area, lower the forks, apply the parking brake, switch off, and report any faults.

⚠ Safety

- Never exceed the rated capacity or lift an unstable or damaged pallet.
- Keep people away from the truck's operating area and never allow anyone under raised forks.
- Do not travel with the load raised high or turn sharply at speed.
- Use the horn and follow site traffic routes, speed limits, and pedestrian separation rules.
- Never carry passengers unless the truck is specifically designed and approved for them.
- If the truck becomes unstable or a fault occurs, follow operator training and emergency procedures; do not jump from a tipping truck.

Care & storage

- Inspect forks, tyres, mast, chains, and reach mechanism before and after use.
- Keep the operator compartment, sensors, and visibility areas clean.
- Charge and maintain the battery according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Report hydraulic leaks, unusual noise, braking problems, or warning indicators promptly.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Operating without checking the capacity plate and load weight.
- Travelling with forks or the load raised too high.
- Turning sharply or travelling too fast in narrow aisles.
- Leaving the forks raised or the truck powered on when parked.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.